

Dr. Heidegger's Experiment

Nathaniel Hawthorne · 1837

First published: Twice-Told Tales, 1837

TEACHER EDITION · CURRICULUM UNIT

AP edition (standards shown for this framework only)

One 90-minute lesson (the whole story), with an optional take-home essay

Syllabus · 90-minute lesson plans · lecture scripts · vocabulary · quizzes with keys · writing prompts at eleven rigor levels · SAT-style items · whole-book test · essays

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Contents and unit overview

1. Unit overview and the 90-minute lesson
2. Syllabus (weekly pacing)
3. Lesson 1: introduction (author, context, reception, overview)
4. Lesson plans and lecture scripts (chapters 1–1), each with vocabulary, discussion questions, annotation focus, quiz and key, writing prompts and SAT-style items
5. Unit test (eleven rigor versions) with answer keys and scoring guides
6. Final paper
7. Essay assignments at eleven rigor levels

Edition: Reading text: https://en.wikisource.org/wiki/Twice-Told_Tales_(1837)/Dr._Heidegger's_Experiment (revision 11998015), cleaned for Liber et Libri.

Grades: Grades 9–12 (accessible text, well suited to the scaffolded-support track; scales to graduate via rigor levels). Short story: read whole in one 90-minute lesson (assign longer stories as pre-reading). The scaffolded-support track works from the full text with scaffolds. **Weeks:** 1. **Class days:** 2 × 90 minutes (1 chapter lessons plus seminar, test and essay days).

Essential questions

- What does Dr. Heidegger's Experiment suggest about youth and folly?
- What does Dr. Heidegger's Experiment suggest about the desire to relive the past?
- What does Dr. Heidegger's Experiment suggest about human nature?

Objectives

- Students will cite at least 2 quotations, with locations, to support each written claim about what the text says explicitly and implicitly (scored on the writing-prompt rubric).
- Students will trace one theme across at least 3 sections of the story in the final paper, earning at least 70 of 100 rubric points.
- Students will explain how characters, setting and point of view interact in at least 3 exit tickets, each meeting the claim-evidence-reasoning criteria.
- Students will determine the in-context meaning of taught vocabulary, scoring at least 80% on the vocabulary items of the story quizzes.
- Students will write an argument with a clear claim, reasons and relevant evidence, scoring at least 80% on the unit test's short-answer scoring guides.

Standards: AP

AP-LIT.CHR, AP-LIT.SET, AP-LIT.STR, AP-LIT.NAR, AP-LIT.FIG, AP-LIT.LAN

AP English Literature and Composition big ideas (our summaries; apcentral.collegeboard.org)

Assessments: Daily story quizzes (auto-graded); Weekly writing prompt (rubric); Socratic seminars (scheduled days); Whole-story test (scheduled day); Final essay (scheduled day); College Sophomore and above write one essay of the five
Differentiation: Every prompt and quiz has eleven rigor levels (Scaffolded support through Graduate / PhD); the app applies student override, then class standard, then the automatic level. Each prompt is tagged for Common Core, Indiana 2023, Dual Credit (Indiana College Core), AP and Cambridge where they apply.
Materials: Liber et Libri reader; Annotation journal; Story lecture slides or script

The 90-minute lesson

#	Segment	Mode	Minutes	Clock
1	Bell-ringer	You do	8	0–8
2	Vocabulary with etymology notes	I do	10	8–18
3	Background and context	I do	10	18–28
4	I do: modeled close reading	I do	12	28–40
5	We do: guided annotation	We do	15	40–55
6	You do: independent annotation	You do	15	55–70
7	Discussion	We do	10	70–80
8	Exit ticket / chapter quiz	You do	7	80–87
9	Closure	I do	3	87–90
	Total		**90**	

Syllabus

Week	Chapters	Lessons	Focus and activities	Assessment
1	*Introduction: author, context and reception* Dr. Heidegger's Experiment	2 × 90 min (180 min)	*youth and folly* • Daily 90-minute lesson: bell-ringer, vocabulary and word histories, background, I do / We do / You do, discussion, exit ticket, closure • Story quizzes in the app • Introduction: author, context and reception • Writing prompt at assigned rigor (one graded per week)	Quiz average plus one graded writing prompt

Lesson plans and lecture scripts

Each chapter is one 90-minute class. Scripts are a starting point; adapt them to your students. Teacher summaries contain spoilers.

Lesson 1: Introduction to Dr. Heidegger's Experiment

Objective: Students will explain, in a 3-sentence exit ticket, how one fact about Nathaniel Hawthorne's life or times connects to youth and folly in “Dr. Heidegger's Experiment”, and will set up a reading journal with a prediction and a question for each of 3 themes (youth and folly, the desire to relive the past, human nature).

Standards: AP: see the unit standards

Author biography

Nathaniel Hawthorne was born in Salem, Massachusetts, on 4 July 1804; his ancestor John Hathorne was a judge in the Salem witch trials of 1692, a family history Hawthorne felt as a burden. He later changed the spelling of his surname to Hawthorne; why is uncertain, though many link it to his discomfort with his ancestors. After graduating from Bowdoin College in 1825 he spent years writing in near-seclusion in Salem, publishing Twice-Told Tales in 1837. He lived briefly at the utopian Brook Farm community, worked at the Salem Custom House, and achieved fame with The Scarlet Letter (1850) and The House of the Seven Gables (1851). He served as U.S. consul in Liverpool and died on 19 May 1864 in Plymouth, New Hampshire.

Historical and cultural context

The story plays on the legend of the Fountain of Youth, which tradition (not evidence) links to the Spanish explorer Juan Ponce de León in Florida. The 1830s were also a time of popular quack medicine and "scientific" curiosity.

Publication and reception, then and now

First published as "The Fountain of Youth" in the Knickerbocker magazine in January 1837; collected in Twice-Told Tales (1837) under its present title.

Then: One of the tales that made Twice-Told Tales a modest success.

Now: Often taught with "The Minister's Black Veil" as a short, clear example of Hawthorne's allegory and irony.

Overview (spoiler-free)

Old Dr. Heidegger invites four elderly friends, each ruined by vanity, greed or pleasure, to test water from the Fountain of Youth.

Main themes

- failure to learn from experience.
- vanity and the desire for youth.
- science and folly.

Why it matters

The story questions whether people really change, and pokes at today's obsession with staying young.

Spoilers · teacher only

They grow young and repeat all their old follies, fighting over the widow; the vase breaks, the effect fades, and instead of learning the lesson they resolve to go to Florida and drink there forever.

Lesson plan (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Before we open Dr. Heidegger's Experiment: If you could go back and do one thing differently, would you? Would you actually change?
Prompt: Before we open Dr. Heidegger's Experiment: If you could go back and do one thing differently, would you? Would you actually change?

8–18 min · Key terms · I do (10 min)
Key literary terms for the unit.
allegory; irony; satire; frame narrator; Fountain of Youth.

18–28 min · Mini-lecture: author, context, reception · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture on the author, the historical context and the reception (read or adapt the script).
About the author. Nathaniel Hawthorne was born in Salem, Massachusetts, on 4 July 1804; his ancestor John Hathorne was a judge in the Salem witch trials of 1692, a family history Hawthorne felt as a burden. He later changed the spelling of his surname to Hawthorne; why is uncertain, though many link it to his discomfort with his ancestors. After graduating from Bowdoin College in 1825 he spent years writing in near-seclusion in Salem, publishing Twice-Told Tales in 1837. He lived briefly at the utopian Brook Farm community, worked at the Salem Custom House, and achieved fame with The Scarlet Letter (1850) and The House of the Seven Gables (1851). He served as U.S. consul in Liverpool and died on 19 May 1864 in Plymouth, New Hampshire. The world of the book. The story plays on the legend of the Fountain of Youth, which tradition (not evidence) links to the Spanish explorer Juan Ponce de León in Florida. The 1830s were also a time of popular quack medicine and "scientific" curiosity. Publication and reception. First published as "The Fountain of Youth" in the Knickerbocker magazine in January 1837; collected in Twice-Told Tales (1837) under its present title. Then: One of the tales that made Twice-Told Tales a modest success. Now: Often taught with "The Minister's Black Veil" as a short, clear example of Hawthorne's allegory and irony.

28–40 min · I do: the book in one passage · I do (12 min)
Model a close reading of one passage using the written think-aloud below.
First, meaning. I read "That very singular man, old Dr. Heidegger, once invited four venerable friends to meet him in his study." slowly and put it in my own words: The very strange old Dr. Heidegger invites four old friends into his study. Next, craft. I notice the word "singular" and "venerable," formal words that set a mysterious tone. The strongest word is "singular": it means peculiar, which hints that his experiment will be odd and maybe sly. Then, effect. What does the first sentence suggest about Dr. Heidegger? My answer: Hawthorne frames the story like a fable with a scientist figure observing people; we expect a lesson.

> *That very singular man, old Dr. Heidegger, once invited four venerable friends to meet him in his study. (Dr. Heidegger's Experiment, paragraph 1)*

Think-aloud: First, meaning. I read "That very singular man, old Dr. Heidegger, once invited four venerable friends to meet him in his study." slowly and put it in my own words: The very strange old Dr. Heidegger invites four old friends into his study. Next, craft. I notice the word "singular" and "venerable," formal words that set a mysterious tone. The strongest word is "singular": it means peculiar, which hints that his experiment will be odd and maybe sly. Then, effect. What does the first sentence suggest about Dr. Heidegger? My answer: Hawthorne frames the story like a fable with a scientist figure observing people; we expect a lesson.

40–55 min · We do: overview and themes · We do (15 min)
Read the spoiler-free overview together and name the themes to track.
What the book is about (no spoilers): Old Dr. Heidegger invites four elderly friends, each ruined by vanity, greed or pleasure, to test water from the Fountain of Youth. Themes to track: failure to learn from experience.: vanity and the desire for youth.: science and folly.:

55–70 min · You do: reading journal · You do (15 min)
Set up a reading journal: one page per theme, with a prediction and a question (example given).
Set up a reading journal: one page per theme with a prediction and a question. Page: the desire to relive the past. Prediction: Dr. Heidegger's four elderly friends will get a chance to be young again. Question: will they use a second youth more wisely than their first?
Task: Set up a reading journal for Dr. Heidegger's Experiment: one page per theme, each with a prediction and a question.
Exemplar: Page: the desire to relive the past. Prediction: Dr. Heidegger's four elderly friends will get a chance to be young again. Question: will they use a second youth more wisely than their first?

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Whole-class discussion: why the book is still taught.
Why does Dr. Heidegger's Experiment still matter? The story questions whether people really change, and pokes at today's obsession with staying young.
Anchor question: Why might Dr. Heidegger's Experiment still be taught today?
Facilitation: The story questions whether people really change, and pokes at today's obsession with staying young.

80–87 min · Exit ticket · You do (7 min)
Exit ticket on the author and context (answer given).
Hawthorne was descended from a Salem judge in the 1692 witch trials and felt guilty about his ancestors. How might that inherited guilt shape his stories? Answer: Accept answers such as: he writes about sin and guilt; he questions moral pride; his stories often look back to Puritan New England.
Exit ticket: Hawthorne was descended from a Salem judge in the 1692 witch trials and felt guilty about his ancestors. How might that inherited guilt shape his stories?
Answer: Accept answers such as: he writes about sin and guilt; he questions moral pride; his stories often look back to Puritan New England.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Preview the first reading.
Tomorrow we begin reading: Dr. Heidegger's Experiment.

Teacher notes · sources: Britannica, "Nathaniel Hawthorne" (https://www.britannica.com/biography/Nathaniel-Hawthorne); The House of the Seven Gables, "Nathaniel Hawthorne" (https://7gables.org/nathaniel-hawthorne/); Hawthorne, Twice-Told Tales (1837) (https://www.gutenberg.org/ebooks/508)

Flags (verify before teaching):

- Our story metadata gives Twice-Told Tales (1837) as first publication; the earlier Knickerbocker appearance (January 1837, as "The Fountain of Youth") should be confirmed.
- The narrator admits he may be called "a fiction-monger" and Heidegger's guests suspect a trick; Hawthorne leaves the water's reality uncertain.

Lesson 2: Dr. Heidegger's Experiment

Focus: the foolishness of wishing to be young again

Objective: Students will analyze how irony develops in "Dr. Heidegger's Experiment" by writing a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph that cites at least 2 quotations from the section, and will score at least 80% on the section quiz.

Standards: AP: see the unit standards

Content note (alcohol or drugs (mentioned)): This section mentions drinking or a drug ("…bursting in silvery spray at the surface. As the liquor diffused a pleasant perfume, the old pe…"). Treat it as period custom or plot detail; name it plainly and don't glamorize it.
Student preview: This section mentions drinking or a drug.
Suggested language: "What does this detail add to the scene?"

Teacher only · spoilers

Old Dr. Heidegger invites four elderly friends, each ruined by vice, to test water from the Fountain of Youth. A withered rose revives in it. The guests drink, grow young, and repeat their old follies: flirting with the widow Wycherly and fighting over her until they knock the vase to the floor. The effect wears off; the rose withers. The doctor has learned his lesson, but the guests resolve to go to Florida to drink from the fountain.

Background: Collected in Twice-Told Tales (1837); Ponce de León's legendary search in Florida is the allusion.

Significance: A tidy moral tale often paired with discussion of whether people learn from experience.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
If you could be ten years older or younger for a day, what would you do differently? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to failure to learn from experience because.... Content note before we start: This section mentions drinking or a drug.
Prompt: If you could be ten years older or younger for a day, what would you do differently?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to failure to learn from experience because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: they resolve to go to Florida.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: exuberant — joyously unrestrained; blossomed — opened into flower; scandalous — giving offense to moral sensibilities and injurious to reputation; gentlewoman — a woman of good family and manners; mentioning — speaking about briefly. "mentioning": Origin of "mention": Old French mention; earlier Latin mentiōnem.
Words: exuberant: joyously unrestrained · blossomed: opened into flower · scandalous: giving offense to moral sensibilities and injurious to reputation · gentlewoman: a woman of good family and manners · mentioning: speaking about briefly

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
Collected in Twice-Told Tales (1837); Ponce de León's legendary search in Florida is the allusion. A tidy moral tale often paired with discussion of whether people learn from experience. Irony: Given a second youth, the guests do exactly what ruined them before. Characterization: Each guest stands for a vice: Mr. Medbourne (greed), Colonel Killigrew (pleasure), Mr. Gascoigne (political ambition), Widow Wycherly (vanity). Symbolism: The withered rose that blooms and withers again mirrors the guests. Watch for the rose: youth and its loss.

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
First, meaning. I read "the "Fountain of Youth" slowly and put it in my own words: Dr. Heidegger tells his friends the water comes from the legendary Fountain of Youth. Next, craft. I notice the quotation marks, which make it sound like a famous story he is borrowing. The strongest word is "Youth": it names what the guests most want back. Then, effect. Why does Heidegger mention "the Fountain of Youth"? My answer: Heidegger mentions "the Fountain of Youth" to give his experiment its stakes: his water comes from that legend, and his old friends will show they would waste youth the same way again.

> *the "Fountain of Youth (Dr. Heidegger's Experiment, paragraph 13)*

Think-aloud: First, meaning. I read "the "Fountain of Youth" slowly and put it in my own words: Dr. Heidegger tells his friends the water comes from the legendary Fountain of Youth. Next, craft. I notice the quotation marks, which make it sound like a famous story he is borrowing. The strongest word is "Youth": it names what the guests most want back. Then, effect. Why does Heidegger mention "the Fountain of Youth"? My answer: Heidegger mentions "the Fountain of Youth" to give his experiment its stakes: his water comes from that legend, and his old friends will show they would waste youth the same way again.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: "Stoop" means to lower himself; Heidegger sees drinking as beneath his dignity. Ask: How does this line connect to failure to learn from experience? Expected: They resolve to go to Florida. (Heidegger's lesson.)

> *I would not stoop to bathe my lips in it (Dr. Heidegger's Experiment, paragraph 51)*

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: "Stoop" means to lower himself; Heidegger sees drinking as beneath his dignity.
Ask: How does this line connect to failure to learn from experience?
Expected answer: They resolve to go to Florida. (Heidegger's lesson.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).
Annotate the story for irony, characterization (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this story suggest about the foolishness of wishing to be young again? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Dr. Heidegger's Experiment develops the idea of the foolishness of wishing to be young again. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of irony and symbolism shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: Hawthorne suggests that age does not bring wisdom unless people reflect on their mistakes. When the text says "I would not stoop to bathe my lips in it" (Dr. Heidegger's Experiment, paragraph 51), it shows this directly. The guests repeat their follies at once, while Heidegger, having watched them, says "I would not stoop to bathe my lips in it" and calls it "the lesson ye taught me."
Task: Annotate the story for irony, characterization (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this story suggest about the foolishness of wishing to be young again? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Dr. Heidegger's Experiment develops the idea of the foolishness of wishing to be young again. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of irony and symbolism shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
Exemplar: Hawthorne suggests that age does not bring wisdom unless people reflect on their mistakes. When the text says "I would not stoop to bathe my lips in it" (Dr. Heidegger's Experiment, paragraph 51), it shows this directly. The guests repeat their follies at once, while Heidegger, having watched them, says "I would not stoop to bathe my lips in it" and calls it "the lesson ye taught me."

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.
Anchor question: If you could be ten years older or younger for a day, what would you do differently? Ask: what would you do with the water? What does your answer say?
Anchor question: If you could be ten years older or younger for a day, what would you do differently?
Facilitation: Ask: what would you do with the water? What does your answer say?

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Story quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Story quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this story suggest about the foolishness of wishing to be young again? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: Hawthorne suggests that age does not bring wisdom unless people reflect on their mistakes. ("I would not stoop to bathe my lips in it", Dr. Heidegger's Experiment, paragraph 51). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the story; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this story suggest about the foolishness of wishing to be young again? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: Hawthorne suggests that age does not bring wisdom unless people reflect on their mistakes. ("I would not stoop to bathe my lips in it", Dr. Heidegger's Experiment, paragraph 51). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the story; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how irony shapes the foolishness of wishing to be young again. Key takeaway: they resolve to go to Florida.

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Irony:** Given a second youth, the guests do exactly what ruined them before.
- **Characterization:** Each guest stands for a vice: Mr. Medbourne (greed), Colonel Killigrew (pleasure), Mr. Gascoigne (political ambition), Widow Wycherly (vanity).
- **Symbolism:** The withered rose that blooms and withers again mirrors the guests.

Themes and how they develop

- **failure to learn from experience:** they resolve to go to Florida.

Symbols and motifs

- **the rose:** youth and its loss.

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- "the "Fountain of Youth" (Dr. Heidegger's Experiment, paragraph 13) The legend.
- "I would not stoop to bathe my lips in it" (Dr. Heidegger's Experiment, paragraph 51) Heidegger's lesson.
- "Such is the lesson ye have taught me" (Dr. Heidegger's Experiment, paragraph 51) His conclusion.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: Hawthorne suggests that age does not bring wisdom unless people reflect on their mistakes.
Evidence: "I would not stoop to bathe my lips in it" (Dr. Heidegger's Experiment, paragraph 51)
Reasoning: The guests repeat their follies at once, while Heidegger, having watched them, says "I would not stoop to bathe my lips in it" and calls it "the lesson ye taught me."

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
exuberant (adjective)	joyously unrestrained	*They were a group of merry youngsters, almost maddened with the exuberant frolicksomeness of their years.*	
blossomed (verb)	opened into flower	*Heidegger, with a sigh, 'this same withered and crumbling flower, blossomed five-and-fifty years ago.*	
scandalous (adjective)	giving offense to moral sensibilities and injurious to reputation	*As for the Widow Wycherly, tradition tells us that she was a great beauty in her day; but, for a long while past, she had lived in deep seclusion, on account of certain scandalous stories, which had prejudiced the gentry of the town against her.*	
gentlewoman (noun)	a woman of good family and manners	*Gascoigne, and a withered gentlewoman, whose name was the Widow Wycherly.*	
mentioning (verb)	speaking about briefly	*It is a circumstance worth mentioning, that each of these three old gentlemen, Mr.*	"mentioning": Origin of "mention": Old French mention; earlier Latin mentiōnem. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/mention#Etymology)
doubtfully (adverb)	in an uncertain or unsure way	*In the obscurest corner of the room stood a tall and narrow oaken closet, with its door ajar, within which doubtfully appeared a skeleton.*	"doubtfully": Origin of "doubtful": an English formation from doubt + -ful. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/doubtful#Etymology)

Discussion questions

1. If you could be ten years older or younger for a day, what would you do differently?
2. Where does irony appear in this story, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this story connect to the book's larger concern with youth and folly?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Scaffolded support: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. What is in the vase? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · AP: unit standards] Look for: Water from the Fountain of Youth
2. What does the doctor test first? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · AP: unit standards] Look for: A dried rose from fifty-five years ago
3. Whom do the three men fight over? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · AP: unit standards] Look for: The Widow Wycherly
4. What happens when the vase breaks? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · AP: unit standards] Look for: The water spills and the effect fades
5. What do the guests decide to do? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · AP: unit standards] Look for: Travel to Florida to find the fountain
6. Retell the three most important events of “Dr. Heidegger's Experiment” in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · AP: unit standards] Look for: Old Dr. Heidegger invites four elderly friends, each ruined by vice, to test water from the Fountain of Youth. A withered rose revives in it. The guests drink, grow young, and repeat their old follies: flirting with the widow Wycherly and fighting over her until they knock the vase to the floor. The effect wears off; the rose withers. The doctor has learned his lesson, but the guests resolve to…
7. Which characters appear or are mentioned in “Dr. Heidegger's Experiment”? Name two and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · AP: unit standards] Look for: Names and actions taken from the story; check against the teacher summary.
8. Where and when does “Dr. Heidegger's Experiment” take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · AP: unit standards] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the story.
9. Reread: “They were a group of merry youngsters, almost maddened with the exuberant frolicksomeness of their years.” What does “exuberant” mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · AP: unit standards] Look for: exuberant: joyously unrestrained.
10. Reread: “Heidegger, with a sigh, 'this same withered and crumbling flower, blossomed five-and-fifty years ago.” What does “blossomed” mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · AP: unit standards] Look for: blossomed: opened into flower.

Inferential / analytical

1. What does “Dr. Heidegger's Experiment” suggest about the foolishness of wishing to be young again? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · AP-LIT.LAN] Look for: A tidy moral tale often paired with discussion of whether people learn from experience.

2. Find one example of irony in this story. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · AP-LIT.NAR] Look for: Look for gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true.
3. How does the symbolism in this story shape what we understand about the foolishness of wishing to be young again? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · AP-LIT.FIG] Look for: Look for objects, places or actions that stand for larger ideas.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Hawthorne suggests that age does not bring wisdom unless people reflect on their mistakes. Useful evidence: “the "Fountain of Youth” (Dr. Heidegger's Experiment, paragraph 13): The legend. On symbolism: The withered rose that blooms and withers again mirrors the guests. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
4. In the passage that begins “'This rose,' said Dr.”, why might Hawthorne have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · AP-LIT.FIG] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
5. What causes the main turn in “Dr. Heidegger's Experiment”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · AP-LIT.STR] Look for: Old Dr. Heidegger invites four elderly friends, each ruined by vice, to test water from the Fountain of Youth. A withered rose revives in it. The guests drink, grow young, and repeat their old follies: flirting with the widow Wycherly and fighting over her until they knock the vase to the floor….
6. As the opening story, what does “Dr. Heidegger's Experiment” set up that the rest of Dr. Heidegger's Experiment will need? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · AP-LIT.STR] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous story.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Hawthorne suggests that age does not bring wisdom unless people reflect on their mistakes. Useful evidence: “I would not stoop to bathe my lips in it” (Dr. Heidegger's Experiment, paragraph 51): Heidegger's lesson. Theme link: they resolve to go to Florida. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
7. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say and do here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · AP-LIT.CHR] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Hawthorne suggests that age does not bring wisdom unless people reflect on their mistakes. Useful evidence: “Such is the lesson ye have taught me” (Dr. Heidegger's Experiment, paragraph 51): His conclusion. On characterization: Each guest stands for a vice: Mr. Medbourne (greed), Colonel Killigrew (pleasure), Mr. Gascoigne (political ambition), Widow Wycherly (vanity). Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. The bell-ringer asked: “If you could be ten years older or younger for a day, what would you do differently?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · AP-LIT.LAN] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
9. Where does characterization appear, and how does it connect this story to the larger concern with youth and folly? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · AP-LIT.CHR] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Hawthorne suggests that age does not bring wisdom unless people reflect on their mistakes. Useful evidence: “the "Fountain of Youth” (Dr. Heidegger's Experiment, paragraph 13): The legend. On characterization: Each guest stands for a vice: Mr. Medbourne (greed), Colonel Killigrew (pleasure), Mr. Gascoigne (political ambition), Widow Wycherly (vanity).

Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. Background: Collected in Twice-Told Tales (1837); Ponce de León's legendary search in Florida is the allusion. How does knowing this change the way you read one moment in the story? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · AP-LIT.SET] Look for: A specific moment reread in light of the context.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Hawthorne suggests that age does not bring wisdom unless people reflect on their mistakes. Useful evidence: “I would not stoop to bathe my lips in it” (Dr. Heidegger's Experiment, paragraph 51): Heidegger's lesson. Theme link: they resolve to go to Florida. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. A critic might argue: “A tidy moral tale often paired with discussion of whether people learn from experience.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the story. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · AP-LIT.LAN] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Hawthorne suggests that age does not bring wisdom unless people reflect on their mistakes. Useful evidence: “Such is the lesson ye have taught me” (Dr. Heidegger's Experiment, paragraph 51): His conclusion. Theme link: they resolve to go to Florida. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. Which character in this story acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · AP-LIT.CHR, AP-LIT.LAN] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Hawthorne suggests that age does not bring wisdom unless people reflect on their mistakes. Useful evidence: “the "Fountain of Youth” (Dr. Heidegger's Experiment, paragraph 13): The legend. On characterization: Each guest stands for a vice: Mr. Medbourne (greed), Colonel Killigrew (pleasure), Mr. Gascoigne (political ambition), Widow Wycherly (vanity). Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
3. Rewrite one moment of “Dr. Heidegger's Experiment” from the point of view of a different character. What does the new angle reveal or hide about the foolishness of wishing to be young again? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · AP-LIT.LAN, AP-LIT.NAR] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Hawthorne suggests that age does not bring wisdom unless people reflect on their mistakes. Useful evidence: “I would not stoop to bathe my lips in it” (Dr. Heidegger's Experiment, paragraph 51): Heidegger's lesson. Theme link: they resolve to go to Florida. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
4. Write three questions of your own about “Dr. Heidegger's Experiment”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · AP-LIT.LAN] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Hawthorne suggests that age does not bring wisdom unless people reflect on their mistakes. Useful evidence: “Such is the lesson ye have taught me” (Dr. Heidegger's Experiment, paragraph 51): His conclusion. Theme link: they resolve to go to Florida. Credit

any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Connect this story to the desire to relive the past: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Hawthorne need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · AP-LIT.LAN] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Hawthorne suggests that age does not bring wisdom unless people reflect on their mistakes. Useful evidence: “the "Fountain of Youth” (Dr. Heidegger's Experiment, paragraph 13): The legend. Theme link: they resolve to go to Florida. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
6. Is the irony in this story effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · AP-LIT.LAN, AP-LIT.NAR] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Hawthorne suggests that age does not bring wisdom unless people reflect on their mistakes. Useful evidence: “I would not stoop to bathe my lips in it” (Dr. Heidegger's Experiment, paragraph 51): Heidegger's lesson. On irony: Given a second youth, the guests do exactly what ruined them before. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
7. Compare how “Dr. Heidegger's Experiment” treats the foolishness of wishing to be young again with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Dr. Heidegger's Experiment see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · AP-LIT.LAN] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Hawthorne suggests that age does not bring wisdom unless people reflect on their mistakes. Useful evidence: “Such is the lesson ye have taught me” (Dr. Heidegger's Experiment, paragraph 51): His conclusion. Theme link: they resolve to go to Florida. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. As the final story, does this ending resolve youth and folly? Argue whether the ending is earned. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · AP-LIT.LAN, AP-LIT.STR] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Hawthorne suggests that age does not bring wisdom unless people reflect on their mistakes. Useful evidence: “the "Fountain of Youth” (Dr. Heidegger's Experiment, paragraph 13): The legend. Theme link: they resolve to go to Florida. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this story (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about the foolishness of wishing to be young again? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · AP-LIT.LAN] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Hawthorne suggests that age does not bring wisdom unless people reflect on their mistakes. Useful evidence: “I would not stoop to bathe my lips in it” (Dr. Heidegger's Experiment, paragraph 51): Heidegger's lesson. Theme link: they resolve to go to Florida. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. What question would you most like to ask Nathaniel Hawthorne about this story, and what answer do you think the text itself gives? [DOK 4 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · AP-LIT.LAN] Look for: A student-generated question answered from evidence.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Hawthorne suggests that age does not bring wisdom unless people reflect on their mistakes. Useful evidence: “Such is the lesson ye have taught me” (Dr.

Heidegger's Experiment, paragraph 51): His conclusion. Theme link: they resolve to go to Florida. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Irony:** look for gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Symbolism**: objects, places or actions that stand for larger ideas
- Also notice **Characterization**: what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "In the obscurest corner of the room stood a tall and narrow oaken closet, with its door ajar, within which _____ appeared a skeleton." Word bank: exuberant, doubtfully, blossomed, scandalous

   Key: doubtfully
2. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "It is a circumstance worth _____, that each of these three old gentlemen, Mr." Word bank: blossomed, exuberant, scandalous, mentioning

   Key: mentioning
3. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from Dr. Heidegger's Experiment, paragraph 51: "Such is the _____ ye have taught me"

   Key: lesson
4. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Whom do the three men fight over?

   A. No one
   B. A maid
   C. The doctor's niece
   D. The Widow Wycherly

   Key: D (The Widow Wycherly)
5. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What does the doctor test first?

   A. His own hand
   B. A butterfly
   C. A dead mouse
   D. A dried rose from fifty-five years ago

   Key: D (A dried rose from fifty-five years ago)
6. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What happens when the vase breaks?

   A. The water spills and the effect fades
   B. The doctor dies
   C. Nothing changes
   D. They become babies

   Key: A (The water spills and the effect fades)

7. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What is in the vase?
   A. Water from the Fountain of Youth
   B. Wine
   C. Poison
   D. Rose oil

   Key: A (Water from the Fountain of Youth)
8. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What do the guests decide to do?
   A. Travel to Florida to find the fountain
   B. Stay young forever
   C. Repent
   D. Thank the doctor

   Key: A (Travel to Florida to find the fountain)
9. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? “the "Fountain of Youth” (Dr. Heidegger's Experiment, paragraph 13) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.
   Sample answer: The legend.
10. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? “I would not stoop to bathe my lips in it” (Dr. Heidegger's Experiment, paragraph 51) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.
    Sample answer: Heidegger's lesson.
11. [mc · inference · DOK 2] Which choice best states a central concern of “Dr. Heidegger's Experiment”?
    A. Friendship tested by duty
    B. Self-destruction and the urge to do wrong
    C. A symbol of hidden sin that isolates its wearer
    D. The foolishness of wishing to be young again

    Key: D (The foolishness of wishing to be young again)
12. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in “Dr. Heidegger's Experiment”? Given a second youth, the guests do exactly what ruined them before.
    A. Setting
    B. Hyperbole
    C. Structure
    D. Irony

    Key: D (Irony)
13. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Claim: Hawthorne suggests that age does not bring wisdom unless people reflect on their mistakes. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “I would not stoop to bathe my lips in it” (Dr. Heidegger's Experiment, paragraph 51).
    Sample answer: The guests repeat their follies at once, while Heidegger, having watched them, says "I would not stoop to bathe my lips in it" and calls it "the lesson ye taught me."
14. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Analyze the word choice in “Such is the lesson ye have taught me” (Dr. Heidegger's Experiment, paragraph 51). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.
    Sample answer: His conclusion.

15. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in “Dr. Heidegger's Experiment”? Each guest stands for a vice: Mr. Medbourne (greed), Colonel Killigrew (pleasure), Mr. Gascoigne (political ambition), Widow Wycherly (vanity).

    A. Plot

    B. Characterization

    C. Point of view

    D. Irony

    Key: B (Characterization)

16. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “I would not stoop to bathe my lips in it” (Dr. Heidegger's Experiment, paragraph 51) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    Sample answer: Heidegger's lesson.

17. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Evaluate this claim about the story: “Hawthorne suggests that age does not bring wisdom unless people reflect on their mistakes.” Is it fully persuasive? Argue with evidence, including a passage that complicates it.

    Sample answer: The guests repeat their follies at once, while Heidegger, having watched them, says "I would not stoop to bathe my lips in it" and calls it "the lesson ye taught me."

18. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Synthesis: trace how failure to learn from experience develops from an earlier story to “Dr. Heidegger's Experiment”. Use one quotation from each.

    Sample answer: they resolve to go to Florida.

19. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “the "Fountain of Youth” (Dr. Heidegger's Experiment, paragraph 13) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    Sample answer: The legend.

20. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “Gascoigne, and a withered gentlewoman, whose name was the Widow Wycherly.”, what does “gentlewoman” most nearly mean?

    A. a woman of good family and manners

    B. joyously unrestrained

    C. opened into flower

    D. giving offense to moral sensibilities and injurious to reputation

    Key: A (a woman of good family and manners)

21. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “As for the Widow Wycherly, tradition tells us that she was a great beauty in her day; but, for a long while past, she had lived in deep seclusion, on account of certain scandalous stories, which had prejudiced the…”, what does “scandalous” most nearly mean?

    A. a woman of good family and manners

    B. joyously unrestrained

    C. giving offense to moral sensibilities and injurious to reputation

    D. opened into flower

    Key: C (giving offense to moral sensibilities and injurious to reputation)

22. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “Heidegger, with a sigh, 'this same withered and crumbling flower, blossomed five-and-fifty years ago.”, what does “blossomed” most nearly mean?

    A. joyously unrestrained

B. giving offense to moral sensibilities and injurious to reputation

C. opened into flower

D. a woman of good family and manners

Key: C (opened into flower)

23. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “They were a group of merry youngsters, almost maddened with the exuberant frolicksomeness of their years.”, what does “exuberant” most nearly mean?

A. giving offense to moral sensibilities and injurious to reputation

B. a woman of good family and manners

C. opened into flower

D. joyously unrestrained

Key: D (joyously unrestrained)

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
Scaffolded support	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16	recall 8, inference 3, analysis 4, synthesis 1
HS Freshman	1, 8, 4, 3, 6, 7, 5, 2, 11, 9, 10, 12, 14, 15, 13, 17	recall 8, inference 3, analysis 4, synthesis 1
HS Sophomore	3, 7, 4, 6, 1, 8, 2, 5, 9, 11, 10, 14, 15, 13, 18, 19	recall 8, inference 3, analysis 3, synthesis 2
HS Junior	8, 3, 4, 1, 5, 6, 2, 9, 11, 10, 13, 15, 14, 12, 19, 17	recall 7, inference 3, analysis 4, synthesis 2
HS Senior	2, 5, 1, 4, 3, 6, 10, 9, 11, 12, 14, 13, 15, 19, 16, 18	recall 6, inference 3, analysis 4, synthesis 3
AP	2, 1, 20, 21, 22, 9, 10, 11, 14, 13, 15, 12, 16, 19, 17, 18	recall 5, inference 3, analysis 4, synthesis 4
College Freshman	3, 20, 7, 2, 5, 11, 9, 10, 14, 13, 15, 12, 16, 18, 19, 17	recall 5, inference 3, analysis 4, synthesis 4
College Sophomore	23, 22, 3, 6, 1, 10, 9, 11, 12, 15, 14, 13, 18, 17, 16, 19	recall 5, inference 3, analysis 4, synthesis 4
College Junior	2, 4, 20, 3, 6, 11, 9, 10, 12, 13, 15, 14, 17, 19, 16, 18	recall 5, inference 3, analysis 4, synthesis 4
College Senior	2, 1, 20, 6, 5, 11, 10, 9, 13, 12, 14, 15, 17, 16, 18, 19	recall 5, inference 3, analysis 4, synthesis 4
Graduate / PhD	4, 7, 22, 2, 3, 10, 9, 11, 15, 14, 12, 13, 17, 18, 19, 16	recall 5, inference 3, analysis 4, synthesis 4

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Scaffolded support (250 words; AP: see unit standards): Supported track (work from the passage your teacher selects). In “Dr. Heidegger's Experiment,” how does Hawthorne show the foolishness of wishing to be young again? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the irony you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; AP: see unit standards): In Dr. Heidegger's Experiment, how does Hawthorne develop the idea of the foolishness of wishing to be young again? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the irony in the story helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; AP: see unit standards): Analyze how Dr. Heidegger's Experiment develops the idea of the foolishness of wishing to be young again. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of irony and symbolism shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; AP: see unit standards): Analyze how the structure of Dr. Heidegger's Experiment (where it begins, turns and ends) and its irony shape the reader's understanding of the foolishness of wishing to be young again. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning. Distinguish what is directly stated from what is really meant.

HS Senior (600 words; AP: see unit standards): Two readers disagree about what Dr. Heidegger's Experiment suggests about the foolishness of wishing to be young again. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the story's irony and symbolism), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay. Distinguish what is directly stated from what is really meant.

AP (650 words; AP: AP-LIT.NAR, AP-LIT.LAN): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Nathaniel Hawthorne uses irony in Dr. Heidegger's Experiment to complicate the reader's understanding of the foolishness of wishing to be young again. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; AP: see unit standards): Situate Dr. Heidegger's Experiment within its historical and literary context and argue how the story's treatment of the foolishness of wishing to be young again responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; AP: see unit standards): Read Dr. Heidegger's Experiment alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the story's handling of the foolishness of wishing to be young again follows or bends those conventions, using the irony as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; AP: see unit standards): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Dr. Heidegger's Experiment and its treatment of the foolishness of wishing to be young again. State your method, show what it reveals in the story's irony and symbolism, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; AP: see unit standards): Develop a research argument that reads Dr. Heidegger's Experiment as evidence for a larger claim about the foolishness of wishing to be young again in Dr. Heidegger's Experiment. Connect close reading of the story to the whole story, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; AP: see unit standards): Develop an original argument that reads Dr. Heidegger's Experiment as a hinge in the story's larger treatment of the foolishness of wishing to be young again. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Dr. Heidegger's Experiment.

SAT-style questions

1. *As for the Widow Wycherly, tradition tells us that she was a great beauty in her day; but, for a long while past, she had lived in deep seclusion, on account of certain scandalous stories, which had prejudiced the gentry of the town against her.*

As used in the text, what does the word "scandalous" most nearly mean?

A. speaking about briefly

B. giving offense to moral sensibilities and injurious to reputation

C. in an uncertain or unsure way

D. a woman of good family and manners

2. *'This rose,' said Dr. Heidegger, with a sigh, 'this same withered and crumbling flower, blossomed five-and-fifty years ago. It was given me by Sylvia Ward, whose portrait hangs yonder; and I meant to wear it in my bosom at our wedding. Five-and-fifty years it has been treasured between the leaves of this old volume. Now, would you deem it possible that this rose of half a century could ever bloom again?'*

Which choice best states a central concern of "Dr. Heidegger's Experiment"?

A. A symbol of hidden sin that isolates its wearer

B. A story told to protect a livelihood

C. Self-destruction and the urge to do wrong

D. The foolishness of wishing to be young again

SAT key: 1. B (giving offense to moral sensibilities and injurious to reputation); 2. D (The foolishness of wishing to be young again)

Unit test

Dr. Heidegger's Experiment: end test · 90 minutes · 18 questions per rigor version (multiple choice, fill in the blank, short answer). The class rigor level picks the version; student auto-adjust applies.

Short-answer scoring guides

Scaffolded support and HS Freshman (2 points): correct answer in a complete sentence with a detail from the text. HS Sophomore to HS Senior (3 points): claim, one accurate quotation, one sentence of explanation. AP to College Sophomore (4 points): precise claim, two embedded quotations, commentary on word choice or structure, link to theme. College Junior to Graduate (5 points): nuanced thesis, close reading of two passages, synthesis across sections, a competing reading answered. Each item lists a sample answer; partial credit is described in the app.

Unit test: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “It is a circumstance worth _____, that each of these three old gentlemen, Mr.” Word bank: blossomed, exuberant, scandalous, mentioning
   Key: mentioning
2. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What happens when the vase breaks?
   A. The water spills and the effect fades
   B. The doctor dies
   C. Nothing changes
   D. They become babies
   Key: A (The water spills and the effect fades)
3. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from Dr. Heidegger's Experiment, paragraph 51: “Such is the _____ ye have taught me”
   Key: lesson
4. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “In the obscurest corner of the room stood a tall and narrow oaken closet, with its door ajar, within which _____ appeared a skeleton.” Word bank: exuberant, doubtfully, blossomed, scandalous
   Key: doubtfully
5. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What is in the vase?
   A. Water from the Fountain of Youth
   B. Wine
   C. Poison
   D. Rose oil
   Key: A (Water from the Fountain of Youth)
6. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Whom do the three men fight over?
   A. No one
   B. A maid
   C. The doctor's niece
   D. The Widow Wycherly

Key: D (The Widow Wycherly)

7. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What do the guests decide to do?

   A. Travel to Florida to find the fountain

   B. Stay young forever

   C. Repent

   D. Thank the doctor

   Key: A (Travel to Florida to find the fountain)

8. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What does the doctor test first?

   A. His own hand

   B. A butterfly

   C. A dead mouse

   D. A dried rose from fifty-five years ago

   Key: D (A dried rose from fifty-five years ago)

9. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? “the "Fountain of Youth” (Dr. Heidegger's Experiment, paragraph 13) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

   Sample answer: The legend.

10. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? “I would not stoop to bathe my lips in it” (Dr. Heidegger's Experiment, paragraph 51) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: Heidegger's lesson.

11. [mc · inference · DOK 2] Which choice best states a central concern of “Dr. Heidegger's Experiment”?

    A. Friendship tested by duty

    B. Self-destruction and the urge to do wrong

    C. A symbol of hidden sin that isolates its wearer

    D. The foolishness of wishing to be young again

    Key: D (The foolishness of wishing to be young again)

12. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Claim: Hawthorne suggests that age does not bring wisdom unless people reflect on their mistakes. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “I would not stoop to bathe my lips in it” (Dr. Heidegger's Experiment, paragraph 51).

    Sample answer: The guests repeat their follies at once, while Heidegger, having watched them, says "I would not stoop to bathe my lips in it" and calls it "the lesson ye taught me."

13. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Analyze the word choice in “Such is the lesson ye have taught me” (Dr. Heidegger's Experiment, paragraph 51). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.

    Sample answer: His conclusion.

14. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in “Dr. Heidegger's Experiment”? Each guest stands for a vice: Mr. Medbourne (greed), Colonel Killigrew (pleasure), Mr. Gascoigne (political ambition), Widow Wycherly (vanity).

    A. Plot

    B. Characterization

    C. Point of view

    D. Irony

Key: B (Characterization)

15. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in “Dr. Heidegger's Experiment”? Given a second youth, the guests do exactly what ruined them before.

    A. Setting

    B. Hyperbole

    C. Structure

    D. Irony

    Key: D (Irony)

16. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Evaluate this claim about the story: “Hawthorne suggests that age does not bring wisdom unless people reflect on their mistakes.” Is it fully persuasive? Argue with evidence, including a passage that complicates it.

    Sample answer: The guests repeat their follies at once, while Heidegger, having watched them, says "I would not stoop to bathe my lips in it" and calls it "the lesson ye taught me."

17. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “the "Fountain of Youth” (Dr. Heidegger's Experiment, paragraph 13) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    Sample answer: The legend.

18. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Synthesis: trace how failure to learn from experience develops from an earlier story to “Dr. Heidegger's Experiment”. Use one quotation from each.

    Sample answer: they resolve to go to Florida.

19. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “I would not stoop to bathe my lips in it” (Dr. Heidegger's Experiment, paragraph 51) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    Sample answer: Heidegger's lesson.

20. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “Gascoigne, and a withered gentlewoman, whose name was the Widow Wycherly.”, what does “gentlewoman” most nearly mean?

    A. a woman of good family and manners

    B. joyously unrestrained

    C. opened into flower

    D. giving offense to moral sensibilities and injurious to reputation

    Key: A (a woman of good family and manners)

21. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “As for the Widow Wycherly, tradition tells us that she was a great beauty in her day; but, for a long while past, she had lived in deep seclusion, on account of certain scandalous stories, which had prejudiced the…”, what does “scandalous” most nearly mean?

    A. a woman of good family and manners

    B. joyously unrestrained

    C. giving offense to moral sensibilities and injurious to reputation

    D. opened into flower

    Key: C (giving offense to moral sensibilities and injurious to reputation)

22. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “They were a group of merry youngsters, almost maddened with the exuberant frolicksomeness of their years.”, what does “exuberant” most nearly mean?

    A. giving offense to moral sensibilities and injurious to reputation

B. a woman of good family and manners

C. opened into flower

D. joyously unrestrained

Key: D (joyously unrestrained)

23. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “Heidegger, with a sigh, 'this same withered and crumbling flower, blossomed five-and-fifty years ago.”, what does “blossomed” most nearly mean?

A. joyously unrestrained

B. giving offense to moral sensibilities and injurious to reputation

C. opened into flower

D. a woman of good family and manners

Key: C (opened into flower)

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
Scaffolded support	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18	recall 8, inference 3, analysis 4, synthesis 3
HS Freshman	3, 1, 7, 6, 4, 5, 8, 2, 10, 11, 9, 13, 14, 12, 15, 18, 16, 19	recall 8, inference 3, analysis 4, synthesis 3
HS Sophomore	7, 6, 3, 8, 2, 4, 5, 1, 10, 11, 9, 14, 12, 13, 15, 17, 19, 16	recall 8, inference 3, analysis 4, synthesis 3
HS Junior	2, 3, 7, 1, 5, 8, 6, 4, 9, 10, 11, 15, 14, 12, 13, 18, 17, 19	recall 8, inference 3, analysis 4, synthesis 3
HS Senior	1, 2, 3, 7, 6, 5, 8, 4, 11, 10, 9, 15, 12, 14, 13, 17, 19, 18	recall 8, inference 3, analysis 4, synthesis 3
AP	3, 8, 7, 20, 4, 1, 21, 10, 11, 9, 12, 15, 14, 13, 17, 18, 19, 16	recall 7, inference 3, analysis 4, synthesis 4
College Freshman	2, 5, 3, 22, 4, 6, 7, 11, 10, 9, 13, 12, 14, 15, 17, 16, 19, 18	recall 7, inference 3, analysis 4, synthesis 4
College Sophomore	1, 4, 21, 8, 23, 5, 22, 11, 10, 9, 15, 12, 13, 14, 16, 19, 18, 17	recall 7, inference 3, analysis 4, synthesis 4
College Junior	3, 5, 7, 6, 4, 22, 2, 9, 11, 10, 15, 14, 12, 13, 16, 17, 18, 19	recall 7, inference 3, analysis 4, synthesis 4
College Senior	4, 22, 6, 7, 2, 3, 1, 9, 10, 11, 13, 14, 12, 15, 17, 16, 19, 18	recall 7, inference 3, analysis 4, synthesis 4
Graduate / PhD	1, 8, 3, 6, 20, 5, 7, 10, 9, 11, 15, 13, 12, 14, 19, 18, 17, 16	recall 7, inference 3, analysis 4, synthesis 4

Final paper

Dr. Heidegger's Experiment: final paper (formal literary analysis). Choose one prompt.

1. Analyze how Nathaniel Hawthorne develops youth and folly across Dr. Heidegger's Experiment. Trace the idea through at least three moments (beginning, middle and end) and argue what the ending finally suggests.
2. Choose one recurring symbol, image or motif in Dr. Heidegger's Experiment and argue how its meaning changes over the story and why that change matters to the desire to relive the past.
3. Analyze a central character's choices in Dr. Heidegger's Experiment. Argue whether the story judges that character, and how its structure or point of view shapes your answer.
4. Two readers disagree about whether Dr. Heidegger's Experiment finally endorses or criticizes its society's view of human nature. Weigh both readings and argue for one, answering the strongest objection.

Length: Scaffolded support 500-700 words; HS Freshman 700-900 words; HS Sophomore 900-1,100 words; HS Junior 1,000-1,300 words; HS Senior 1,200-1,500 words; AP 1,300-1,600 words; College Freshman 1,500-2,000 words; College Sophomore 2,000-2,500 words; College Junior 2,500-3,000 words; College Senior 3,000-4,000 words; Graduate / PhD 4,000-6,000 words

Evidence requirement: at least 4 quotations from at least two parts of the story. Quote the reading text exactly and cite the paragraph (MLA style). HS Senior and above: one scholarly or historical source; College Sophomore and above: two, cited in MLA.

Criterion	Points	Descriptor
Thesis	20	A specific, arguable claim that answers the prompt and organizes the paper.
Evidence	25	Well-chosen, accurately quoted and cited passages from across the work, meeting the evidence requirement.
Analysis	30	Explains how language, structure and literary elements create meaning; goes beyond summary.
Organization	15	Logical progression, clear topic sentences and transitions; introduction and conclusion frame the argument.
Style and conventions	10	Formal academic voice, present tense for literature, correct grammar and MLA format.

Essay assignments

Essay: Youth and folly

Scaffolded support (600 words; AP: see unit standards): Supported track: write a five-paragraph essay explaining what Dr. Heidegger's Experiment teaches about youth and folly. Use at least three quotations from passages your teacher selects from different parts of the book.

HS Freshman (800 words; AP: see unit standards): Write a multi-paragraph essay explaining how Nathaniel Hawthorne develops youth and folly in Dr. Heidegger's Experiment. Use evidence from the beginning, middle and end of the book.

HS Sophomore (1000 words; AP: see unit standards): Write an argumentative essay analyzing how Nathaniel Hawthorne develops youth and folly across Dr. Heidegger's Experiment. Trace the idea through at least three parts of the story and address a counterclaim.

HS Junior (1100 words; AP: see unit standards): Write an analytical essay on how the structure of Dr. Heidegger's Experiment (its order, turns and ending) shapes the meaning of youth and folly. Discuss at least one place where the book leaves the question open.

HS Senior (1200 words; AP: see unit standards): Write a sustained argument comparing two interpretations of youth and folly in Dr. Heidegger's Experiment. Weigh the evidence for each and defend the stronger reading in a mature, well-organized essay.

AP (1300 words; AP: AP-LIT.LAN): Write a literary argument: develop a defensible thesis about how Nathaniel Hawthorne's choices in Dr. Heidegger's Experiment (a recurring element, structure and narration) shape a complex understanding of youth and folly, weigh at least one competing reading, and sustain commentary on well-chosen evidence. Do not merely summarize.

College Freshman (1600 words; AP: see unit standards): Write a researched essay (4–6 pages) that places Dr. Heidegger's Experiment's treatment of youth and folly in its historical context, using at least two scholarly sources.

College Sophomore (2200 words; AP: see unit standards): Write a contextual essay (6–8 pages) on youth and folly in Dr. Heidegger's Experiment that reads the story against its genre and period and engages two published critics. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Junior (2800 words; AP: see unit standards): Write a theoretically informed essay (8–10 pages) on youth and folly in Dr. Heidegger's Experiment. Name your critical method, apply it closely, and acknowledge its limits. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Senior (4000 words; AP: see unit standards): Write a research paper (12–15 pages) with an original argument about youth and folly in Dr. Heidegger's Experiment, engaging at least four scholarly sources in Chicago style. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Graduate / PhD (6000 words; AP: see unit standards): Write a seminar paper (15–20 pages) that intervenes in the critical conversation on youth and folly in Dr. Heidegger's Experiment, engaging the relevant scholarship and textual history. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Rubric: Claim · Evidence · Analysis · Organization · Conventions

Essay: The desire to relive the past

Scaffolded support (600 words; AP: see unit standards): Supported track: write a five-paragraph essay explaining what Dr. Heidegger's Experiment teaches about the desire to relive the past. Use at least three quotations from passages your teacher selects from different parts of the book.

HS Freshman (800 words; AP: see unit standards): Write a multi-paragraph essay explaining how Nathaniel Hawthorne develops the desire to relive the past in Dr. Heidegger's Experiment. Use evidence from the beginning, middle and end of the book.

HS Sophomore (1000 words; AP: see unit standards): Write an argumentative essay analyzing how Nathaniel Hawthorne develops the desire to relive the past across Dr. Heidegger's Experiment. Trace the idea through at least three parts of the story and address a counterclaim.

HS Junior (1100 words; AP: see unit standards): Write an analytical essay on how the structure of Dr. Heidegger's Experiment (its order, turns and ending) shapes the meaning of the desire to relive the past. Discuss at least one place where the book leaves the question open.

HS Senior (1200 words; AP: see unit standards): Write a sustained argument comparing two interpretations of the desire to relive the past in Dr. Heidegger's Experiment. Weigh the evidence for each and defend the stronger reading in a mature, well-organized essay.

AP (1300 words; AP: AP-LIT.LAN): Write a literary argument: develop a defensible thesis about how Nathaniel Hawthorne's choices in Dr. Heidegger's Experiment (a recurring element, structure and narration) shape a complex understanding of the desire to relive the past, weigh at least one competing reading, and sustain commentary on well-chosen evidence. Do not merely summarize.

College Freshman (1600 words; AP: see unit standards): Write a researched essay (4–6 pages) that places Dr. Heidegger's Experiment's treatment of the desire to relive the past in its historical context, using at least two scholarly sources.

College Sophomore (2200 words; AP: see unit standards): Write a contextual essay (6–8 pages) on the desire to relive the past in Dr. Heidegger's Experiment that reads the story against its genre and period and engages two published critics. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Junior (2800 words; AP: see unit standards): Write a theoretically informed essay (8–10 pages) on the desire to relive the past in Dr. Heidegger's Experiment. Name your critical method, apply it closely, and acknowledge its limits. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Senior (4000 words; AP: see unit standards): Write a research paper (12–15 pages) with an original argument about the desire to relive the past in Dr. Heidegger's Experiment, engaging at least four scholarly sources in Chicago style. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Graduate / PhD (6000 words; AP: see unit standards): Write a seminar paper (15–20 pages) that intervenes in the critical conversation on the desire to relive the past in Dr. Heidegger's Experiment, engaging the relevant scholarship and textual history. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Rubric: Claim · Evidence · Analysis · Organization · Conventions

Essay: Human nature

Scaffolded support (600 words; AP: see unit standards): Supported track: write a five-paragraph essay explaining what Dr. Heidegger's Experiment teaches about human nature. Use at least three quotations from passages your teacher selects from different parts of the book.

HS Freshman (800 words; AP: see unit standards): Write a multi-paragraph essay explaining how Nathaniel Hawthorne develops human nature in Dr. Heidegger's Experiment. Use evidence from the beginning, middle and end of the book.

HS Sophomore (1000 words; AP: see unit standards): Write an argumentative essay analyzing how Nathaniel Hawthorne develops human nature across Dr. Heidegger's Experiment. Trace the idea through at least three parts of the story and address a counterclaim.

HS Junior (1100 words; AP: see unit standards): Write an analytical essay on how the structure of Dr. Heidegger's Experiment (its order, turns and ending) shapes the meaning of human nature. Discuss at least one place where the book leaves the question open.

HS Senior (1200 words; AP: see unit standards): Write a sustained argument comparing two interpretations of human nature in Dr. Heidegger's Experiment. Weigh the evidence for each and defend the stronger reading in a mature, well-organized essay.

AP (1300 words; AP: AP-LIT.LAN): Write a literary argument: develop a defensible thesis about how Nathaniel Hawthorne's choices in Dr. Heidegger's Experiment (a recurring element, structure and narration) shape a complex understanding of human nature, weigh at least one competing reading, and sustain commentary on well-chosen evidence. Do not merely summarize.

College Freshman (1600 words; AP: see unit standards): Write a researched essay (4–6 pages) that places Dr. Heidegger's Experiment's treatment of human nature in its historical context, using at least two scholarly sources.

College Sophomore (2200 words; AP: see unit standards): Write a contextual essay (6–8 pages) on human nature in Dr. Heidegger's Experiment that reads the story against its genre and period and engages two published critics. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Junior (2800 words; AP: see unit standards): Write a theoretically informed essay (8–10 pages) on human nature in Dr. Heidegger's Experiment. Name your critical method, apply it closely, and acknowledge its limits. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Senior (4000 words; AP: see unit standards): Write a research paper (12–15 pages) with an original argument about human nature in Dr. Heidegger's Experiment, engaging at least four scholarly sources in Chicago style. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Graduate / PhD (6000 words; AP: see unit standards): Write a seminar paper (15–20 pages) that intervenes in the critical conversation on human nature in Dr. Heidegger's Experiment, engaging the relevant scholarship and textual history. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Rubric: Claim · Evidence · Analysis · Organization · Conventions

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